Accredian Community

Discord-style Learning Network

A native community platform built inside Accredian that keeps learners engaged, helps them network, resolve doubts, and build their career — all without leaving the platform.

Product: Accredian Community · Feature: Native Chat + Network · User: Shant, PM Cohort 7 · Goal: Retention + Networking

1. Background

Help to understand the context behind why we are doing this project.

Accredian is a premium learning platform, but it is not fully leveraging its cohorts to build a community that makes the Accredian experience stand out. Since major competitors like Udemy and Coursera do not offer an interactive community, we can build one to keep learners engaged on the platform.

This can also reduce, to some extent, the number of learners shifting to WhatsApp and make the experience feel more like a classroom and more immersive, instead of just watching videos like on Udemy and Coursera.

People use LinkedIn for two reasons: to connect and build a network, and to get a job through employers and connections. We need to create that same value natively inside Accredian. A Discord-style, web-based chat lets people share what they learned and how the course helped them achieve real-world outcomes. We can also have multiple channels for doubts so learners can help each other, an automatic progress updater, a cohort directory, friend requests, and private DMs.

2. Problem Statement

I am <who>, I am trying to <outcome/job>, But <problem/barrier> because <root cause> which makes me feel <emotion>.

I am **Shant, a 23-year-old working professional enrolled in the Accredian PM course**. I am trying to **level up my skills, switch careers into Product Management, and build a professional network**. But **I cannot communicate with my batchmates or collaborate on assignments** because **Accredian has no built-in way to connect, so I rely on external apps like WhatsApp and LinkedIn**, which makes me feel **like I am just watching videos on Udemy — the price feels less justified and the experience is not classroom-like at all.**

If more students are active on the platform, they should be able to communicate and network through a community feature — similar to Discord, but private to Accredian students. If the community is full of like-minded people who regularly network and collaborate, cohorts will stay more active and retention will increase significantly.

3. Goals

What are your goals for this feature / What will success look like?

The goal of this feature is to increase student retention on the Accredian platform by creating a native community that reduces reliance on external platforms like WhatsApp and LinkedIn. Success will look like:

- Higher course completion rates across cohorts
- Active daily engagement in community channels
- Students building professional networks without leaving the platform
- Average doubt resolution time under 3 minutes
- 40%+ expected improvement in cohort retention
- Zero dependency on external apps like WhatsApp for batch communication

Ultimately, the feature should make every learner feel that Accredian is worth the price — not just for the content, but for the community.

4. Hypothesis & Feature Description

Build a hypothesis for your feature, then explain your feature, what are the different functionalities of your feature & how will they make an impact on the user, and why the user will be inclined to use the feature.

Hypothesis

If we make this chat feature available, we can drive real results, but only if onboarding is very easy for learners and the UI feels attractive rather than generic. Learners should feel like communicating. What we will get is that people will network on the same platform where they learn — they can ask each other doubts, collaborate on assignments, share their learnings, and show their progress. We would see higher cohort retention because learners can communicate across multiple channels. But the real MVP is the community we build through this.

Feature Description

CHANNELS

We can have multiple channels — a channel for all learners, class-specific channels, a wins channel, and a learning channel where learners share what they learned from the class. We can also add levels to profiles, linked to a leaderboard, to make the experience more fun and give it more of a classroom vibe.

VC (VOICE / VIDEO)

A live class “watch together” feature with VC would feel more like a classroom because learners can interact in real time. If someone has a doubt, they can post it in a doubt channel and, since the community is active, get answers from different perspectives.

DMS

If someone wants to discuss something privately, they can use the DMs feature. DMs are critical to reducing WhatsApp migration — learners already have a messaging layer inside Accredian and do not need to go elsewhere.

COHORT RETENTION

With the community being active and online, cohorts stay active too and come back to the same place to learn new skills and be a part of the community. Leaderboards and weekly competitions build a habit of participating and staying active.

AUTOMATIC PROGRESS UPDATER

An automatic progress updater shows that a learner has completed a class, is on a specific lecture, and is enrolled in a course. This creates social proof and accountability within the cohort.

5. Vision Narrative

Tell your use cases in story format, starting before the user encounters your feature and including their thoughts and motivations.

Shant is a 23-year-old working professional who enrolled in Accredian's PM course to switch careers. Three weeks in, Shant is stuck on a case study and opens WhatsApp to find help, but the batch group is dead and everyone has moved on.

While working through this doubt, Shant notices a pop-up at the top of the website inviting learners to ask the community. Curious, Shant clicks and explores what the community is about.

Shant finds cohort profiles that show where people work, their specializations, and different channels for doubts, debates, VC, and learning together. There is a channel for all learners, channels for the specific class Shant is enrolled in, a channel for collaborating on assignments, and DMs — plus leaderboards, weekly competitions, structured discussions, and an introduction channel where Shant can introduce himself.

Shant is genuinely surprised by the platform because the UI is smooth and easy to use. Shant explores more, then posts the doubt in the doubt section. It gets answered from different points of view, and the community can decide which answer is best. Shant feels the money is justified because they can not only learn, but also network with a bunch of cool people in a community that is only accessible to Accredian learners.

USER FLOW

- Student enrolls → starts learning → gets stuck
- A pop-up highly encourages them to ask the community
- Gets answered from multiple perspectives by professionals
- Networks with people in the same class and cohorts via channels and DMs
- WhatsApp is no longer needed — DMs handle it
- Shares learnings in #wins and #learnings channels
- Uses the Accredian network instead of LinkedIn to get a job

6. Key Trade Offs & Decisions

For example, were there any alternatives considered?

Option A — YouTube-style comments under lectures: Add a comment section below each lecture video similar to YouTube. This was rejected because it feels bland and not very interactive. It also does not support networking the way LinkedIn does and creates no persistent community layer.

Option B — Build on Discord: Create an Accredian Discord server for learners. This was rejected because it hurts cohort retention — learners would eventually leave the platform entirely. Any engagement it drives benefits Discord's DAU, not Accredian's retention metrics. Building on Discord is building on someone else's land.

Option C — Native Accredian Community (Selected): Build a Discord-style community within the Accredian website. This makes the experience more immersive, interactive, and fun. It is the only option that keeps engagement, networking, and learning in the same place. Course context makes every interaction richer — a doubt in #pm-doubts is from a real batchmate on the same week, which creates trust that cannot be replicated on Discord or LinkedIn at any scale.

7. Concept Mocks

Include some mocks or a prototype to illustrate the concept. To get an idea about wireframe diagrams click here.

View the full interactive concept mocks here: **https://accredian-community.vercel.app/**

8. Risks & Mitigations

Think of potential loopholes and what could go wrong for your feature. For each risk, plan appropriate mitigations.

Risk	Description & Mitigation
Volume	The community can only thrive if there is a large enough learner base. If cohorts are not active and discussions fade, new learners will not feel motivated to participate, which kills the feature and leads to drop-off. **Mitigation:** Increase overall student volume through marketing and improved acquisition and activation rates. Use nudge popups and onboarding prompts to drive early engagement.
Engagement Drop-off	Students are most active when they are new, because that is when most interaction happens. Over time, engagement fades and learners become less active. **Mitigation:** Add leaderboards, weekly competitions, and recurring challenges to build a habit of participating. Introduce cohort-specific events and watch-together sessions to create recurring reasons to return.

WhatsApp Migration	This is almost unavoidable. If learners become close friends, they will eventually use WhatsApp for personal conversations. We cannot fully prevent this. **Mitigation:** Offer DMs natively so personal conversations can stay within Accredian. Accept that some migration is natural, and focus on keeping professional and course-related communication on platform.
Content Quality & Moderation	An open community can drift off-topic, attract spam, or produce low-quality answers in doubt channels. **Mitigation:** Introduce a “Marked helpful” voting system, community moderation roles, and XP penalties for low-quality or off-topic content. Assign community managers during the initial launch phase.

9. Appendix: Research

Include useful research, such as competitive analysis, metrics, or surveys. Full interactive presentation available at accredian-community.vercel.app.

Competitive Analysis

A comparison of WhatsApp, Discord, and LinkedIn against the proposed Accredian native community feature. All three competitors fail on the same axis: course context. WhatsApp has familiarity but zero course awareness. Discord has the structure but lives on the wrong platform. LinkedIn has professional signal but none of the cohort trust that makes networking actually happen between learners.

View the full competitive analysis and research here: **https://accredian-community.vercel.app/**

Key Data Points

- Discord's average session is 28 minutes — the engagement model works. The only problem is who captures it. Build the same loop natively and that 28 minutes stays on Accredian.
- LinkedIn's average visit is only ~7 minutes — the feed is noisy and use cases are transactional. Accredian can beat this by making the community the daily reason learners open the platform.
- WhatsApp batch groups go dead within weeks with no moderation, no structure, and no course connection.
- Udemy and Coursera do not offer interactive community features — this is a direct competitive differentiator for Accredian.